Adekunle Adeniji

Curatorial Project Leader | Gallery Development and Interpretive Planning

Kingston, Ontario, Canada | +1 343-989-2373 | teminicrownpro@gmail.com

October 30, 2026

Search Committee, Curatorial Project Director, Canada
Royal Ontario Museum
c/o Arts Consulting Group

Re: Curatorial Project Director, Canada (24-month contract)

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the Curatorial Project Director, Canada role at the Royal Ontario Museum. A new Canada Gallery is a chance to tell a national story that more Canadians can see themselves in, and I would be honoured to help lead its vision and conceptual development.

I have built my career where curatorial thinking meets project delivery. As the Samuel and Gabrielle Lurie Fund resident at the Metropolitan Museum of Art, I coordinated collections and interpretation planning for the multimillion-dollar reinstallation of the Michael C. Rockefeller Wing. I aligned curatorial, conservation, registration, education, and design teams, routed interpretive content through multi-stage review, and kept documentation and milestones in step with a fixed public opening. The wing reopened on schedule in May 2025. During the residency I also researched and wrote three essays published on the Met's Heilbrunn Timeline of Art History.

That experience maps closely to the bridge this role provides between curatorial leadership, the project team, and museum management. I plan timelines, budgets, research, and risk; I document decisions and next steps after every planning meeting; and I give leaders the updates they need to decide quickly. At the Denver Art Museum, I collaborated with community advisors to shape exhibitions and public programming, which taught me that the strongest interpretation is built with communities, not only for them. Today I lead a program at Emole Futures Initiative in Kingston, where I set objectives with the executive team, manage budgets across four concurrent workstreams, and report outcomes to executives and external partners.

My graduate training in Art History at Queen's University, together with a Graduate Certificate in Project Management from Sheridan College and current studies in digital product management at the Smith School of Business, gives me both the scholarly grounding and the delivery discipline a gallery of this scale requires.

Thank you for your consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I can contribute to this landmark project.

Sincerely,

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Curatorial project leader with an MA in Art History and more than four years joining curatorial research with project management on major museum projects, including the multimillion-dollar reinstallation of the Michael C. Rockefeller Wing at the Metropolitan Museum of Art, which reopened on schedule in May 2025. Shapes interpretive content and planning with curatorial, conservation, registration, education, and design teams; plans timelines, budgets, research, and risk; and provides the updates and documentation museum leadership needs to make decisions. Brings published scholarship, collaboration with community advisors, and formal training across the full project lifecycle.

CORE SKILLS

Curatorial Project Leadership | Interpretive Planning | Exhibition and Gallery Development | Curatorial Research and Writing | Cross-functional Team Leadership | Timeline and Budget Management | Risk Management | Decision Documentation and Executive Reporting | Stakeholder and Community Engagement | Scope and Change Control | Multi-stage Review and Approvals | Public Presentations

SELECTED PROJECT MANAGEMENT COMPETENCIES

- **Integration management:** developing project charters and integrated plans, consolidating work across disciplines into a single schedule and budget baseline, and controlling change through documented requests and approvals
- **Scope management:** eliciting requirements from curatorial and institutional stakeholders, writing scope statements, and controlling scope creep through early identification and formal change routing
- **Schedule and cost:** identifying critical path and dependencies, baselining budgets, monitoring spend, and forecasting to completion
- **Stakeholders and communications:** analysing stakeholders, planning engagement, and producing status reports and executive summaries that document decisions and next steps
- **Risk management:** identifying risks and workflow gaps, assessing probability and impact, and planning mitigation and contingency responses

WORK EXPERIENCE

Project Manager and Program Lead — 2025 – Present

Emole Futures Initiative Inc., Kingston, Ontario

- Lead the Black Youth in Business program with the executive team, defining program parameters and objectives and translating them into documented scope, deliverables, and integrated plans across four concurrent workstreams.
- Draft budgets, schedules, and milestone plans; monitor spend and analyse variance; and escalate scope changes to leadership while they remain small enough to absorb.
- Recruit, schedule, and supervise program assistants and volunteer mentors, and apply quality review to facilitator output.
- Present dashboards and outcome summaries that translate delivery and budget data into decision-ready formats for executives and external stakeholders.
- Designed and analysed a 27-question community intake survey and applied evaluation methods to measure outcomes against objectives.

Project Coordinator, Arts of Africa (Curatorial Residency) — January 2025 – July 2025

The Metropolitan Museum of Art, New York, NY

- Coordinated collections and interpretation planning as the Samuel and Gabrielle Lurie Fund resident within the multimillion-dollar reinstallation of the Michael C. Rockefeller Wing, a multidisciplinary gallery project delivered against a fixed, publicly announced opening date.
- Aligned curatorial, conservation, registration, education, and design teams on interpretation deliverables, consulting the appropriate specialists for input and approvals on content, timing, and display decisions.
- Researched and wrote gallery interpretation and three published essays for the Heilbrunn Timeline of Art History, translating complex scholarship into clear, accessible content for varied audiences.
- Routed interpretive content through multi-stage review and approval cycles, tracking versions, milestones, and deadlines so print and digital deliverables stayed synchronized with the installation schedule.
- Documented outcomes and next steps from cross-team planning meetings, escalated schedule risks to senior staff, and delivered presentations to staff and stakeholders; the wing reopened on schedule in May 2025.

Exhibition Project Coordinator and Curatorial Fellow — January 2022 – May 2023

Denver Art Museum, Denver, CO

- Coordinated exhibition deliverables and budgets across concurrent projects with fixed opening dates, balancing competing priorities to stay on schedule and within budget.
- Collaborated with community advisors to shape exhibitions and public programming, incorporating stakeholder feedback into scope and content decisions.
- Managed gallery labels, catalogue copy, and digital interpretive content from drafting through approval and final output.

- Handled and installed sculpture, textiles, and works on paper to professional museum standards in coordination with registration and conservation.

Project and Curatorial Intern **July 2021 – November 2021**

Smithsonian National Museum of African Art, Washington, DC

- Supported exhibition planning and public engagement across curatorial, conservation, and registration teams, applying federal-standard intake, documentation, and object-handling protocols.

EDUCATION

Master of Digital Product Management **Expected 2027**

Smith School of Business, Queen's University, Kingston, Ontario

Graduate Certificate, Project Management (Co-op) **2026**

Sheridan College, Ontario

Master of Arts, Art History **2025**

Queen's University, Kingston, Ontario

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

- **Google Project Management Certificate** – Scope, schedules, risk, Agile, and stakeholder management
- **Google Agile Project Management** – Sprint frameworks, Scrum events, and Agile delivery
- **IBM, Agile Development and Scrum** – User stories, backlog refinement, and sprint execution
- **SkillUp, Introduction to the Scrum Master Profession** – Scrum roles, ceremonies, and servant leadership
- **IBM, Generative AI for Product Managers** and IBM, Product Management: An Introduction
- **LinkedIn Learning, 2026:** PM Foundations: Requirements, Schedules, and Stakeholders; Preventing Scope Creep; Requirements Elicitation; Learning Gantt Charts; Project Management Simplified